

How to Pull Your Numbers From a BLS Page

NAME _____ DATE _____ PERIOD _____

BLS is the Bureau of Labor Statistics. It is the government office that counts jobs and pay in the United States. Every career gets one page. Every page is built the same way, so once you can read one, you can read all of them.

Do these 6 steps for each career

1. **Open the BLS page for your career.** Your teacher has the three links on the board.
2. **Look at the very top of the page for the box called Quick Facts.** It is a small table. The left side names the fact. The right side gives the number.
3. **Find the pay row.** It starts with a year, like "2024 Median Pay." Copy the dollar amount **per year**, not per hour. Write it in the **BLS National Median** row on your worksheet.
4. **Find the row called Typical Entry-Level Education.** Copy it word for word. It will say something like "Bachelor's degree" or "High school diploma or equivalent." Write it in the **Typical Education** row.
5. **Find the row called Job Outlook.** It gives a percent and a set of years, like "17% (2023-2033)." Copy the percent. Write it in the **Job Growth Rate** row.
6. **Find the row called Number of Jobs.** Copy the number. Write it on the back of your worksheet.

Then click the tab across the top of the page that says **What They Do**. Read the first paragraph and write **one sentence** in your own words on the back of your worksheet.

Which row goes where

YOUR WORKSHEET ROW	THE QUICK FACTS ROW TO COPY	WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE
BLS National Median	The row that starts with a year and says Median Pay	A dollar amount per year
Typical Education	Typical Entry-Level Education	A school level, in words
Job Growth Rate	Job Outlook	A percent and a set of years
Number of Jobs (back side)	Number of Jobs	A large number
What they do (back side)	Not in Quick Facts. Use the What They Do tab.	One sentence you write

Rows you can skip

Quick Facts also lists **Work Experience in a Related Occupation**, **On-the-job Training**, and **Employment Change**. You do not need those three today. Skip them.

Three things that trip people up

- **Per year, not per hour.** The pay row shows both. Copy the year amount. The hourly amount is a much smaller number.
- **Median is not starting pay.** Median means the middle of everyone in that career. A brand new worker usually earns less than the median.
- **The year in front of Median Pay changes.** BLS updates it. Copy whatever year is on the page today, and write that year next to your number so you know how fresh it is.